

What You Can Make with Claude

faculty projects, ordered from familiar text toward unfamiliar code

Each row names a *kind* of thing you can make: quick examples on the left, one **unpacked** on the right — situation, inputs, operations, outputs, and the interface that fits (`CHAT` `COWORK` `CODE`). Start where you have expertise; climb when you're ready.

TEXT — WHAT YOU ALREADY DO —————> MORE COMPLEX —————> **CODE — WHAT YOU CAN NOW BUILD**

1

Structured Text & Documents

MOST FAMILIAR

EXAMPLES

- Email to a chair proposing a new course
- Grant Specific Aims page from a project description
- Committee report from raw meeting notes
- Recommendation letter from a CV and a prompt
- Syllabus skeleton from a reading list

UNPACKED

Meeting notes → a clean report for the dean

SITUATION

Messy notes from a faculty meeting; a structured report due tomorrow.

INPUTS

meeting-notes.md — your raw bullet points.

OPERATIONS

One prompt: "turn these into a report with a summary, decisions made, and action items with owners and dates."

OUTPUTS

report.md, or a polished .docx on request.

BEST FIT

`CHAT` `COWORK` `CODE IF REPEATED MONTHLY`

2

Reference Pages

static HTML

INTRO TO CODE

EXAMPLES

- A searchable glossary of course terms
- A one-page syllabus website
- A printable command/reference dashboard
- An illustrated lecture handout
- A course-policy FAQ page

UNPACKED

A glossary your students can search and copy from

SITUATION

One page holding every key term in your course, searchable, works offline.

INPUTS

glossary.md — terms and definitions.

OPERATIONS

"Build a single-file HTML page with a search box and click-to-copy, styled for comfortable reading."

OUTPUTS

glossary.html — one file you can email or host anywhere.

BEST FIT

`CODE` `COWORK`

3

Web Apps

Next.js

MORE COMPLEX

EXAMPLES

- A course website with interactive concept demos
- A reading-response collection app
- An interactive timeline of a period or movement
- A "build your own X" student exercise

UNPACKED

Course site for GENED 1049 East Asian Cinema

SITUATION

A site pairing a cinematography glossary with demos built on the films you actually teach.

INPUTS

Syllabus, Rashomon stills, glossary text.

OPERATIONS

Scaffold a Next.js app, build parametric demo components, deploy to Vercel.

OUTPUTS

A live site (gened-1049.vercel.app) you share by link.

BEST FIT

`CODE`

4 Bots & Connected Tools

MCP, Slack

TODAY'S TOPIC

EXAMPLES

- Claude connected to Semantic Scholar for live literature search
- An art-history lecture pulling live images from Harvard Art Museums
- A Slack bot that answers from your course materials
- An oral-exam practice bot
- Claude connected to your Google Drive

UNPACKED

Live literature search via the Semantic Scholar MCP

SITUATION

Real papers with real citation counts and DOIs — not citations the model might invent.

INPUTS

Your research question; a free API key in .mcp.json.

OPERATIONS

"Find recent papers on X, get details, find related work, save." Claude chains search → get-paper → recommend.

OUTPUTS

A markdown literature summary with real DOIs.

BEST FIT

`CODE` MCP SERVERS RUN HERE

5 Data Visualizations

d3, three.js

EVEN MORE COMPLEX

EXAMPLES

- A 2D semantic-embedding map of a text corpus
- An interactive chart of course-evaluation trends
- A 3D model of a molecule, artifact, or building
- A network graph of citations or characters
- An animated explainer for a hard concept

UNPACKED

Calvino's Six Memos, by the numbers

SITUATION

Students see literary qualities as a measurable space — and plot their own prose against it.

INPUTS

The five memos as text; definitions for each measure.

OPERATIONS

Deterministic text analysis + a 2D embedding map + a live draft composer, charts drawn in d3.

OUTPUTS

A live page where pasted prose appears in every chart in real time.

BEST FIT

`CODE`

6 Agentic Pipelines & Systems

MOST COMPLEX

EXAMPLES

- Close-reading a whole corpus with parallel subagents
- A reproducible coding pipeline for interview transcripts
- An automated weekly research digest (scheduled)
- A recommendation engine grounded in institutional data

UNPACKED

Naming every writer cited across 538 Dylan songs

SITUATION

A close reading at corpus scale — every author named in any lyric, with the line quoted — not a keyword grep.

INPUTS

The full corpus of songs (or transcripts, or a long text).

OPERATIONS

Spawn parallel close-reading subagents, each told to read like a scholar and refuse to grep; aggregate.

OUTPUTS

One aggregated JSON plus a prose writeup pairing each name with its quoted line.

BEST FIT

`CODE` SUBAGENTS, SCALE

The arc of the week in one page: everything above is the same loop — inputs in a folder, an operation that transforms them, outputs you can hand to someone. What changes as you descend is only how much of the loop is code. Worked versions of nearly every row live in this repo's **examples/more-examples/**.

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